

GREENWOOD-SLIDELL VFD

FIREFIGHTER I

Lecture slides for the GSVFD Firefighter Taskbook

NFPA 1010 (2024) Chapter 6 · SFFMA Firefighter I · Modules 1–17

HOW THIS COURSE RUNS

1
Lecture
Short classroom session from these slides. Instructor signs K.

2
Drill stations
Explain, demonstrate, imitate, practice. Instructor signs D.

3
Perform alone
On a later drill day, no coaching, full PPE. Certified evaluator signs P.

4
SFFMA exams
Training uploaded to Portal, then the written and skills exams.

Firefighter I: 17 modules, about 42 classroom hours and 77 drill hours. Hazmat Awareness and Operations run as a separate course.

ANYONE CAN STOP TRAINING

Call **“STOP, STOP, STOP”** on the radio or out loud. Everything freezes until the safety officer clears it.

- Every drill has a named lead instructor and safety officer.
- Rehab after every SCBA bottle or 45 minutes of work.
- Manikins, never live people, for drags, carries and ladder rescues.
- Gross decon and a shower within an hour after any smoke exposure.

MODULE 1

ORIENTATION, SAFETY AND HEALTH

Taskbook 1.1–1.3 | SFFMA: written exam | 4 hr class

By the end of this module you can:

- Describe GSVFD's organization, chain of command and SOPs
- Explain the 16 Firefighter Life Safety Initiatives and two-in / two-out
- Name the leading causes of firefighter deaths and how to prevent them
- Recognize behavioral distress and know where to get help

STAYING ALIVE AND HEALTHY ON THIS JOB

What kills firefighters

Sudden cardiac events and vehicle crashes lead most years. Fitness and seat belts save lives.

The risk rule

Risk a lot only to save savable lives. Risk little to save property. Risk nothing for what is already lost.

Two in, two out

Two firefighters enter together and two stay outside, ready to rescue. Accountability tags every time.

Cancer prevention

Gross decon on scene, bag your gear, shower within an hour, keep the cab clean.

Behavioral health

Watch for sleep trouble, anger, withdrawal and drinking, in yourself and others. Reach out early.

The standards

NFPA 1010 for your skills, 1550 for safety, 1580 for health, 1850 for gear care.

MODULE 2

PPE AND SCBA

Taskbook 1.4–1.5a, 1.10–1.14 | SFFMA FF I #16, #22, #23 | 3 hr class · 9 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Inspect, don and doff structural PPE without contaminating yourself
- Name respiratory hazards and the parts of the SCBA
- Don SCBA by each department method and manage your air
- Handle SCBA emergencies, change cylinders, pass a restricted opening

YOUR GEAR PROTECTS YOU ONLY IF IT IS RIGHT

The ensemble

Helmet, hood, coat, pants, gloves, boots and SCBA, built to NFPA 1970. No skin showing.

Its limits

Gear traps body heat, can hide how hot it is around you, and wet gear can scald you.

Donning

Pants and boots, coat, hood, SCBA, helmet, gloves. GSVFD standard: 60 seconds.

Inspection

Check each piece for tears, burns, worn reflective trim and contamination. Clean, repair or replace.

Doffing clean

Gross decon first, then remove gear without touching your face or neck. Bag it for cleaning.

Care

Routine cleaning after every fire, advanced cleaning by the department process, per NFPA 1850.

SCBA: YOUR AIR IS YOUR EXIT PLAN

Why you need it

Low oxygen, heat, smoke particles, carbon monoxide and hydrogen cyanide.

Daily check

Cylinder full, PASS works, low-air alarm sounds, facepiece seals and is clean.

Air management

Controlled breathing. Know your air before you go in, and be out before the low-air alarm.

Emergencies

Regulator failure, damaged facepiece, low or no air: follow the procedure and call a Mayday.

Tight spaces

Reduced profile first, then loosen straps. The facepiece never comes off.

Cylinder change

Practice on yourself and a partner, by feel, eyes closed, until it is automatic.

MODULE 3

COMMUNICATIONS

Taskbook 1.7–1.9 | SFFMA FF I #1, #10 | 2 hr class · 2 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Take a report of an emergency and relay it to dispatch
- Operate department radios on the right channel
- Tell routine traffic from emergency traffic and evacuation signals
- Answer the station phone and call a Mayday

GOOD RADIO TRAFFIC

1. Think about what you will say.
2. Key the mic, pause one second.
3. Call who you want, then say who you are.
4. Plain language, short and clear.
5. Release; listen for the reply.

Emergency traffic takes priority. Know your evacuation signal per SOP.

MAYDAY — LUNAR

Location
Unit
Name
Air remaining
Resources needed

Lost, trapped, out of air or hurt: call it right away, then hit the emergency button and PASS.

MODULE 4

FIRE BEHAVIOR AND BUILDING CONSTRUCTION

Live-fire prerequisites LF.1–LF.6 | SFFMA: written exam | 6 hr class

By the end of this module you can:

- Explain combustion, heat transfer and the stages of fire
- Recognize flashover, backdraft and smoke-explosion warning signs
- Read smoke and explain flow path and door control
- Name construction types I–V and collapse warning signs

HOW A ROOM FIRE GROWS

1 · Incipient

Small fire, plenty of air. An extinguisher can still win.

2 · Growth

Hot gas layer builds at the ceiling. Modern furnishings get here fast.

3 · Fully developed

Everything in the room burning. Often limited by air, not fuel.

4 · Decay

Fuel or air runs low. Add air and it can come right back.

Flashover

Rapid heat rise, rollover, smoke pushing down. Cool the gases or get out.

Backdraft

Air-starved fire, smoke-stained windows, puffing smoke. Do not open it up.

Flow path

Opening a door or window feeds the fire. Control the door; cool before you advance.

KNOW WHAT THE BUILDING WILL DO

Type	Construction	Watch for
I	Fire-resistive	Heat held in concrete; contents fire
II	Noncombustible	Unprotected steel sags and fails
III	Ordinary (masonry)	Fire in voids and the roof
IV	Heavy timber	Huge fuel load, long burns
V	Wood frame	Lightweight trusses fail early

Collapse warning signs

- Sagging roof or floors
- Cracks or bulging walls
- Spongy feel underfoot
- Fire in a truss space
- Long burn time

In our district: pole barns, metal buildings and manufactured homes burn fast and fail early.

MODULE 5

SCENE SAFETY, APPARATUS AND REFERENCES

Taskbook 1.6, 1.15–1.16 | SFFMA FF I #13, #14, #21 | 2 hr class · 2 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Mount, ride and dismount apparatus safely
- Set up and work inside a protected roadway work area
- Recognize wire, solar, battery and rural scene hazards
- Find answers in the SOPs and the Emergency Response Guidebook

THE SCENE CAN HURT YOU BEFORE THE FIRE DOES

Riding

Seated and belted before the wheels move. Hearing protection on. Nobody rides outside the cab.

Dismounting

Face the apparatus, three points of contact, and step out away from traffic.

Roadways

Block with the apparatus, cone taper upstream, vest on, never turn your back to traffic.

Downed wires

Every wire is energized until the utility says otherwise. Keep everyone well back.

Solar and batteries

Panels make power in daylight even with the main off. Batteries can reignite and give off toxic gas.

Rural hazards

Gas well pads, pipelines and pump jacks, livestock, and rough terrain.

MODULE 6

ROPES AND KNOTS

Taskbook 1.18–1.19 | SFFMA FF I #24 | 1 hr class · 3 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Tell life-safety rope from utility rope
- Inspect rope and take it out of service
- Tie the required knots wearing gloves
- Hoist each listed tool with the correct knot

SIX KNOTS, EVERY TOOL

Knot	Main use
Clove hitch	Start a hoist on a tool or pole
Half hitch	Keep the tool aligned while hoisting
Figure-8	Stopper; base of other knots
Figure-8 on a bight	Loop to clip or drop over an object
Bowline	Loop that will not slip or jam
Safety knot	Backs up every knot's loose end

Rope rules

- Life-safety rope is for people only (NFPA 2500)
- Inspect and log after every use
- Out of service if cut, burned, glazed or soaked in chemicals
- Charged lines go up with the nozzle closed

MODULE 7

FORCIBLE ENTRY

Taskbook 1.20–1.22 | SFFMA FF I #3 | 2 hr class · 4 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Size up a door, window or wall and pick the right tool
- Force inward- and outward-swinging doors with the irons
- Defeat padlocks and clear a window safely
- Breach a wall and leave every opening safe

TRY BEFORE YOU PRY

Size it up

Check if it is unlocked. Which way does it swing? Wood or metal frame? Where are the locks?

Inward door

Gap the door from the jamb, set the fork, then force it in.

Outward door

Gap at the lock or hinge side with the adz, then pry the door out toward you.

Door control

Strap or rope the knob so the door can be closed if conditions change.

Windows

Stand upwind, hands above the glass, strike low, then clear the whole sash.

Locks and walls

Cut the padlock shackle or pull the hasp. Breach walls between studs after checking for wires.

MODULE 8

GROUND LADDERS

Taskbook 1.23–1.25 | SFFMA FF I #4 | 2 hr class · 6 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Name ladder parts and types and choose the right length
- Carry and raise single, roof and extension ladders, alone and in pairs
- Set the climbing angle and place the tip for the job
- Climb, work from and inspect a ladder

LOOK UP, SET IT RIGHT, CLIMB SMOOTH

Look up first

Check for overhead wires before every raise; keep at least 10 ft away. Check the ground too.

Pick the length

A second-story window usually takes a 24-ft ladder; a roof line, 28 ft or more.

About 75 degrees

Base one-quarter of the working length out from the wall.

Tip placement

Rescue: at the sill. Ventilation: beside the window. Roof: several rungs above the edge.

Lock it

Extension ladders: dogs locked and halyard tied off before anyone climbs.

Climb and work

Smooth, hands on the rungs, three points of contact. Leg lock or belt to work.

MODULE 9

HOSE, NOZZLES AND FIRE STREAMS

Taskbook 1.26–1.30 | SFFMA FF I #5 | 3 hr class · 8 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Name hose sizes, couplings and appliances on our apparatus
- Load, carry, advance and extend attack lines
- Operate smooth-bore and fog nozzles without water hammer
- Replace a burst section and work a line from a ladder

GETTING WATER WHERE IT IS NEEDED

Know the hose

Attack lines, supply lines, booster and forestry lines; threaded and Storz couplings.

Loads that deploy

Flat, accordion, minuteman and triple-layer. A bad load means kinks at the door.

Flake at the door

Lay out enough line to reach the fire before it is charged; advance with a backup.

Nozzles

Smooth-bore for reach and penetration; fog for patterns from straight stream to wide fog.

No water hammer

Open and close the bale slowly. Slamming it can burst hose and damage the pump.

Burst length

Clamp or kink above the break, swap the section, restore flow as a two-person team.

MODULE 10

WATER SUPPLY

Taskbook 1.31–1.33 | SFFMA FF I #19 | 2 hr class · 6 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Connect an engine to a hydrant on a forward or reverse lay
- Hand lay a supply line to the engine
- Set up a portable tank and draft from it
- Explain how a tanker shuttle keeps water flowing

THE TANKER SHUTTLE

Fill site

Hydrant, pond, stock tank or dry hydrant. Fill fast and get back on the road.

Dump site

Tanker dumps into the drop tank. Never stand between the tanker and the tank.

Draft

Hard suction and strainer off the bottom; jet siphon moves water between tanks.

Attack engine

Steady water to the attack lines for as long as the fire needs it.

Hydrants

Forward lay goes hydrant to fire; reverse lay goes fire to hydrant. Open fully and slowly, close slowly.

Tight connections

Check gaskets, hand-tight plus a spanner where needed, and no kinks at the intake.

MODULE 11

PORTABLE EXTINGUISHERS

Taskbook 1.34 | SFFMA FF I #2 | 1 hr class · 2 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Name fire classes A, B, C, D and K
- Read extinguisher labels and ratings
- Choose the right extinguisher for the fire
- Put out incipient Class A, B and C fires with a safe approach

RIGHT AGENT, RIGHT APPROACH

Class	Fuel	Use
A	Wood, paper, cloth	Water, ABC dry chemical
B	Flammable liquids, gases	ABC or BC dry chemical, CO2
C	Energized electrical	Dry chemical, CO2; never water
D	Combustible metals	Class D agent only
K	Cooking oils and fats	Wet chemical

PASS

Pull the pin
Aim at the base
Squeeze the handle
Sweep side to side

Approach upwind. Back away facing the fire.

MODULE 12

SEARCH, RESCUE AND FIREFIGHTER SURVIVAL

Taskbook 1.9, 1.17, 1.38–1.40 | SFFMA FF I #10, #17 | 3 hr class · 8 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Run primary and secondary searches as a team
- Remove a victim by drag, carry or ladder
- Rescue a downed firefighter with working or failed SCBA
- Get yourself out when lost, and call the Mayday

SEARCH FAST, SEARCH THOROUGH, STAY TOGETHER

Priorities

Most-threatened victims first: near the fire, then above it, then the rest of the building.

Primary search

Quick sweep of likely victim spots during or right after attack: beds, doorways, windows.

Secondary search

Slow, thorough, by a different crew once the fire is controlled.

Stay oriented

Keep a wall or the hoseline, keep partner contact, and know your way out.

Tenability

Rising heat, falling visibility, fire overhead: report it and back out.

Victim removal

Drags and carries to the nearest safe exit; ladder rescue when stairs are cut off.

FIREFIGHTER SURVIVAL

LOST OR TRAPPED? CALL THE MAYDAY NOW.

Every second you wait is air you will not get back.

1. Call the Mayday with LUNAR.
2. Hit the emergency button; arm the PASS.
3. Control your breathing; save air.
4. Find the hoseline: the female coupling end points to the engine and the way out.
5. Find a wall, a window or a safe haven.
6. If trapped, make noise and point your light up.

MODULE 13

FIRE CONTROL (LIVE FIRE)

Taskbook 1.35–1.37, 1.41 | SFFMA FF I #5, #6, #7, #8 | 4 hr class · 12 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Extinguish exterior Class A fires and protect exposures
- Attack a passenger vehicle fire, including alternative fuels
- Fight a ground cover fire safely with hand tools and water
- Attack an interior fire at, above and below grade as a team

FOUR KINDS OF FIRE, FOUR APPROACHES

Exterior Class A

Piles, sheds, dumpsters. Protect exposures, watch for collapse, break up the material, preserve signs of origin.

Vehicle

Approach from the side at an angle, upwind and uphill. Bumpers, struts and airbags can launch. EVs need lots of water and can reignite.

Ground cover

Anchor and flank, work from the black. LCES: lookouts, communications, escape routes, safety zones.

Interior structure

Read conditions at the door, control the door, cool the gases, then advance. Nozzle, backup and door firefighter work as one.

MODULE 14

VENTILATION

Taskbook 1.42–1.43 | SFFMA FF I #18 | 2 hr class · 5 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Explain why ventilation must be coordinated with fire attack
- Ventilate horizontally by natural, mechanical and hydraulic methods
- Sound a roof and work safely from a roof ladder
- Cut and clear a vertical vent opening

AIR FEEDS FIRE: VENTILATE ONLY WITH WATER READY

On order only

Ventilate when command calls for it and an attack line is in place.

Natural

Open windows and doors, using the wind. Clear the whole opening safely.

Positive pressure

Exhaust opening first, fan set to seal the doorway, never into fire without a line.

Hydraulic

A fog stream aimed out a window pulls smoke out of the room.

On the roof

Sound before every step, work from a secured roof ladder, keep an escape route, stay upwind.

Get off the roof

Sagging, spongy feel, fire through the roof or lightweight trusses: leave now.

MODULE 15

OVERHAUL AND PROPERTY CONSERVATION

Taskbook 1.47–1.49 | SFFMA FF I #9, #15 | 2 hr class · 4 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Find and put out hidden fire without weakening the structure
- Recognize and preserve signs of origin and cause
- Protect contents with covers, water chutes and catch-alls
- Stop sprinkler flow and operate the main control valve

OVERHAUL

- Starts once the fire is controlled
- SCBA stays on: CO and toxic particles remain
- Check walls, ceilings, voids, outlets and fixtures
- Pull ceilings standing between the hole and the exit
- Small, targeted water to limit damage
- Found possible evidence? Stop and tell the officer

PROPERTY CONSERVATION

- Cluster furniture and cover it
- Build water chutes and catch-alls
- Cover roof, window and door openings
- Stop a sprinkler head with a wedge or stopper
- Close the main control valve and report it
- Fold covers for reuse

MODULE 16

UTILITIES, LIGHTING AND AIR MONITORING

Taskbook 1.44–1.46 | SFFMA FF I #11, #12, #20 | 2 hr class · 3 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Shut off electric, natural gas, propane and water service safely
- Set up and run scene lighting within the manufacturer's limits
- Start and bump-test the department gas monitor
- Recognize monitor alarms and act on them

CONTROL THE HAZARDS YOU CAN'T SEE

Electric

Main breaker or disconnect off. Never pull a meter unless the SOPs allow it.

Natural gas

Quarter-turn the meter valve so the tang crosses the pipe. The utility relights.

Propane and water

Close the tank valve clockwise. Water off at the curb stop or main valve.

Scene lighting

Generator away from exhaust paths, cords routed safe, GFCI reset, lights out of drivers' eyes.

Gas monitor

Fresh-air zero and bump test at start-up. Oxygen, flammable gas, CO and often H2S.

When it alarms

Back out, warn others, report the reading, ventilate if ordered. Never just silence it.

MODULE 17

EQUIPMENT AND HOSE MAINTENANCE

Taskbook 1.50–1.56 | SFFMA FF I #25, #26 | 1 hr class · 3 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Clean and check ladders, SCBA, rope, tools and fans
- Wash, inspect, mark and reload fire hose
- Complete apparatus check sheets and report defects
- Clean structural PPE after a fire

THE CALL ISN'T OVER UNTIL THE TRUCK IS READY

SCBA

Clean, check and refill per NFPA 1850 and the manufacturer. Tag out anything defective.

Ladders

Clean and inspect. Out of service if the heat sensor has changed or damage is found.

Rope and tools

Inspect, wash and log rope. Clean tools, check heads and handles, light oil on metal.

Hose

Wash, dry, check couplings and gaskets, mark defects. Never load wet hose.

Your gear

Routine cleaning after every fire; advanced cleaning through the department process.

Write it down

Complete the truck check sheet and logs. Report every defect, every time.

FIREFIGHTER I COMPLETE

NEXT STEPS

1. Every task signed at P in the taskbook
2. Chief signs the interior release
3. Training uploaded to the SFFMA Portal
4. SFFMA written and skills exams
5. On to Firefighter II

